# Chapter 3 — Opening the centre

The bishop pair is a long-term asset. In the following position White has completed development and must decide how to open the centre before Black castles. Note how the knight on f3 supports the advance of the d-pawn, and how the rook can follow along the e-file once the pawns are exchanged.

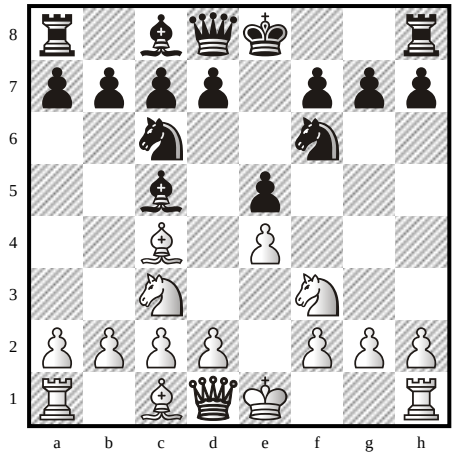


*Diagram 12 — White to move*

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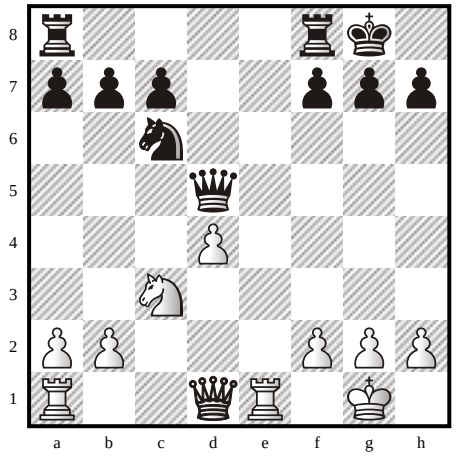


*Diagram 13 — Black to play and win*

# Exercises — answers

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| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 |
| 9 | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 |
| 17 | 18 | 19 | 20 | 21 | 22 | 23 | 24 |
| 25 | 26 | 27 | 28 | 29 | 30 | 31 | 32 |
| 33 | 34 | 35 | 36 | 37 | 38 | 39 | 40 |
| 41 | 42 | 43 | 44 | 45 | 46 | 47 | 48 |
| 49 | 50 | 51 | 52 | 53 | 54 | 55 | 56 |
| 57 | 58 | 59 | 60 | 61 | 62 | 63 | 64 |

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